

Now, to answer your question about the technology itself. When you consider how identity is validated across India, think about hotels. When you say you have a reservation, they ask for your name and find your booking. Then, they ask for your ID card, which they photocopy. This is all unencrypted data being shared with someone. What we're trying to do is build a much more privacy-preserving ecosystem where data sharing is controlled by the passengers themselves.

When they share their identity and travel credentials, it's shared on a secure channel directly with the airport. They share it before they travel, so when they arrive at the airport, their status is "ready to fly," meaning they don't need to interact with anyone. Imagine you're conducting important meetings and flying. You don't want any issues at the airport or arguments with someone who might be picky about your boarding pass name match. You want to walk through seamlessly, which is what we're enabling in Digi Yatra.

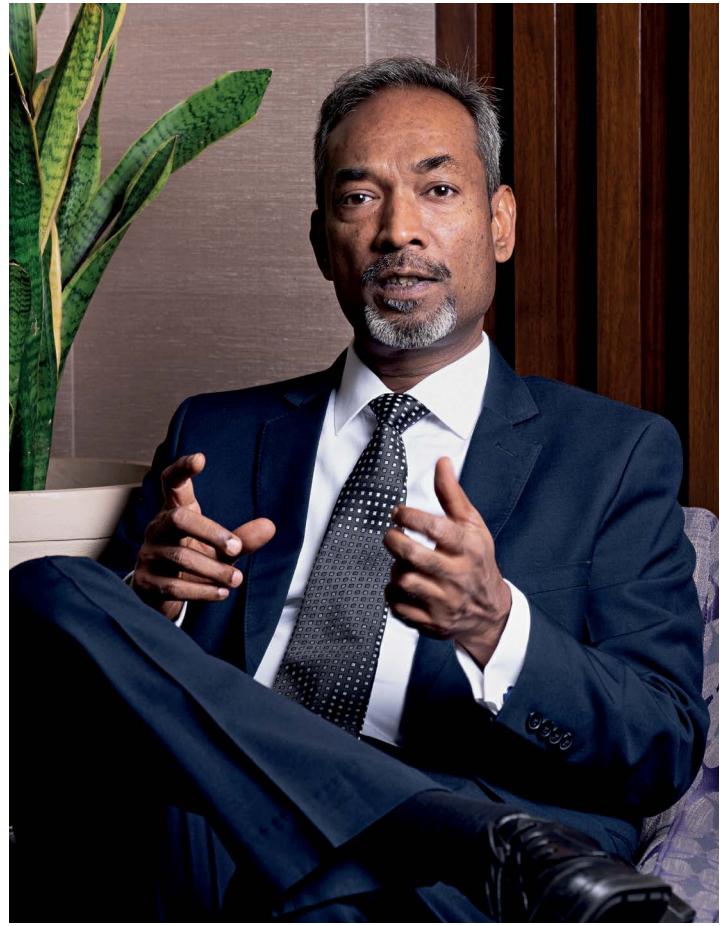
44 | Let's get to the technology itself. We've leveraged cutting-edge sovereign identity technology. It uses verifiable credentials. Basically, we create verifiable credentials, and your phone has a [digital] wallet that stores the credential. When you upload a boarding pass, this is what happens: there's a check to see if the name on the boarding pass matches the name on the identity credential. If there's a match, then the identity credential and boarding pass are sent to the airport.

Q: How can you convince users that their data is private and secure with a private, non-profit entity like Digi Yatra?

A: Enrolling requires your mobile number and OTP for verification. Then, facial data is retrieved from a trusted source like Aadhaar number, including your name and a digital image. This data is sent to our biometric matching algorithm, which performs a one-to-one match. We look at the date of birth, Aadhaar number, face, name and gender. Once matched, your selfie is stored in your identity credential [in your phone's digital wallet] and your Aadhaar card image is discarded.

Q: So, to confirm, this data is not stored locally anywhere in any server?

A: No, it won't be stored on anyone's server or repository. That's how self-sovereign identity works—there's no personally identifiable information on the distributed ledger. What we do is create a signature. When we create the credential, a data string is generated, and a hash value is created. We add that signature, and then the data is stored on your phone, in your wallet. When you



“A tightly knit process needs to be established [to use Digi Yatra on international flights]... other countries are willing to partner with us on pilot programmes”

travel, you upload your boarding pass, and the name match happens. The two data points—your identity credential and boarding pass—are sent to the airport. This is similar to the current process, where you scan your boarding card, which is manually verified with the airline's departure control system... [but] we allow you to share this data in advance. The only additional data we collect is your face, which is stored in the credential and sent to the airport's back-end system.

Q: There was confusion when the previous Digi Yatra app ceased to function, and a new,